

Place initial test requirements in the setUp() method to run automatically before each test to make code more efficient and consistent.

In the sample test case (Cards 8.2 and 8.4), we define widths and lengths in each test function. Instead, we can define width and length in setUp() and use the values in each test function:

```
class AFTestCase(unittest.TestCase):  
    """Tests for area_functions.py."""  
  
    def setUp(self):  
        """Create widths and lengths for all tests."""  
        self.width = 3  
        self.length = 4
```

Then the test method would look like this:

```
def test_rect_area(self):  
    """Test a simple rectangle."""  
    area = af.area_rect(  
        self.width, self.length)  
    self.assertEqual(area, 12)
```

This setUp() function is short. In a real-world test with complicated input values, the setUp() function makes test code more efficient and ensures consistency across many tests.